Herbert *Gracia*

Brand & Creative Leader

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I build brands from the first idea to the products, campaigns, and *experiences people connect with.*

Brand and creative leader with 20+ years across brand strategy, creative direction, design, marketing, and communications. Co-founded and exited two apparel brands, FAZE Apparel (acquired, 2019) and State of Flux (partner buyout, 2024), bringing products to market through direct-to-consumer (DTC), e-commerce, wholesale, and business-to-business (B2B) sales. As Assistant Director at USF's Fromm Institute, a higher-education nonprofit, I lead creative, marketing, communications, PR, and technology. Certified in Applied Agentic AI (2026).

2 Apparel brands co-founded & exited · 10% Enrollment growth at Fromm, 2025–2026 · 500+ Outlets syndicated my national press release

EXPERIENCE

2022–Present
San Francisco

Assistant Director, Technology, Marketing & Creative · *Fromm Institute for Lifelong Learning, University of San Francisco*

Lead brand strategy, creative direction, marketing, communications, PR, and technology for USF's nonprofit, higher-education lifelong learning institute (3,000 students a year). Manage 6 student staff; direct 2 engineers at an outside Salesforce development company and 3 vendors; work with 20+ volunteers and a 21-member Board of Directors.

- **Creative Direction & Brand:** Set one visual identity and voice across catalogs, print ads, email, social, the website, and events; designed the 50th Anniversary logo and campaign.
- **Enrollment Marketing:** Built Fromm's marketing from zero into a multi-channel enrollment program (Google, Meta, and LinkedIn ads, social media, email, community partnerships), growing enrollment 10% across 2025–2026.
- **Public Relations:** Ran a lifelong learning survey and wrote its national press release, syndicated through PR Newswire to 500+ news outlets.
- **Media Buying:** Manage a $20K-a-year newspaper ad account with Hearst Media (San Francisco Chronicle, SFGATE) and $3K a month in paid social.
- **Product & Technology:** Built Frommcast, a subscription streaming platform with 3,000+ active users; designed the Fromm website and lead its Salesforce CRM, directing an outside development company; manage a $100K-a-year technology budget, on budget every year.
- **Applied AI:** Building Fromm's AI enrollment chatbot (in development) after completing USF's Certificate in Applied Agentic AI.

Earlier roles here:

- Specialist, Instructional Technology & Media, 2019–2022
- Instructional Technology Manager, 2012–2019
- Program Manager, 2005–2012

2019–2024
San Francisco Bay Area

Co-Founder & Brand Director · *State of Flux*

EXIT: PARTNER BUYOUT · 2024

Co-founded and developed an independent apparel and lifestyle brand alongside my full-time role at Fromm, overseeing creative direction, brand strategy, product development, marketing, and retail operations.

- Designed original products, from embroidered caps and graphic hoodies to upcycled jersey totes, plus our retail store and pop-up spaces.
- Led brand identity, creative direction, campaigns, photography, and e-commerce.

- Built brand partnerships with Pinterest, Timbuk2, and SFMOMA, creating co-branded products for sale plus events and pop-ups.
- Oversaw direct-to-consumer (DTC), e-commerce, wholesale, B2B, and retail sales while managing a team of five.

Sold my ownership stake to my business partner in 2024.

2007–2019

San Francisco

Co-Founder & Brand Director · *FAZE Apparel*

EXIT: FULL COMPANY ACQUISITION · 2019

Co-founded and built an apparel business from initial concept, alongside my role at Fromm, leading brand development, creative direction, marketing, retail strategy, and business operations.

- Art-directed apparel graphics, lookbooks, photography, video, and retail creative.
- Expanded wholesale distribution to more than 10 retail locations, and designed and opened our branded retail store.
- Led trade-show and experiential marketing initiatives in Las Vegas, Miami, Los Angeles, and New York.
- Led a team of five across design, product, marketing, and sales; managed sampling, sourcing, materials, manufacturing, quality control, and production.

The company was acquired by a privately held business, including its brand assets, logos, designs, and intellectual property rights.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certificate in Applied Agentic AI

UNIVERSITY OF SAN FRANCISCO · 2026 · COMPLETED

Also: **AI Certificate Intensive**, 2026 · Completed

EDUCATION

University of San Francisco, B.A., Media Studies and Communication; Minor in Film, 2005

SKILLS

CREATIVE LEADERSHIP	Creative Direction · Art Direction · Design Leadership · Team Leadership
DESIGN	Logos & Identity · Print & Editorial · Merch & Product · Web & Digital · Retail & Event Spaces
BRAND & STORYTELLING	Brand Strategy · Storytelling · Campaign Development · Public Relations (PR)
PRODUCT & SALES	Product Development · DTC & B2B Sales · E-commerce · Brand Partnerships
MARKETING & GROWTH	Integrated Marketing · Digital Marketing · Enrollment Marketing · Budget & Vendor Management
AI & TECHNOLOGY	Agentic AI · AI Creative Workflows · Salesforce Admin · Directing Developers
LANGUAGES	English (full professional) · Spanish (full professional)

TOOLS Adobe Creative Cloud / Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign, Premiere Pro) · Figma · Final Cut Pro · Canva · Salesforce & Marketing Cloud · Mailchimp · Google Analytics · Claude · ChatGPT · GitHub · Cloudflare